

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | SIEM/SOAR | CrowdStrike | Financial Services Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of progressive, hands-on experience protecting complex enterprise environments. I bring senior-level expertise across the full security stack including Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) operations, Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) with CrowdStrike Falcon, vulnerability management, Privileged Access Management (PAM), and enterprise incident response. My career includes designing and building a hybrid Security Operations Centre (SOC), leading major platform deployments across 8,000-user environments, and serving as senior escalation point for high-severity incidents using the NIST 800-61 framework and MITRE ATT&CK. I have deep expertise in Microsoft technologies including Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), and Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM). I am looking to bring this breadth of capability to a senior engineering role within an asset management or financial services environment where robust, well-governed security operations are essential.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM/SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (workspace design, data connectors, analytics rules, KQL playbooks, workbooks); CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; SIEM alert triage and detection engineering
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover) - expert-level deployment, policy management, threat hunting, and optimisation
- **Microsoft Defender Stack:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; 8,000-user enterprise deployment
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, MFA/SSO, Group Policy administration
- **MDM/MAM:** Microsoft Intune; device compliance policies, mobile application management, and Conditional Access enforcement
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM; credential vaulting, just-in-time access, and session monitoring
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus; risk-based remediation tracking and penetration test finding management
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast email security gateway; anti-phishing, URL protection, and security awareness simulation
- **Firewall and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony next-generation firewall; IDS/IPS management; WAF/DDoS protection management; security certificate lifecycle
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61-aligned; senior escalation lead; playbook authoring; MITRE ATT&CK threat modelling
- **Automation and Scripting:** PowerShell scripting; SOAR playbook automation and workflow development
- **Compliance Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, JISC

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (SOAR) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst/Engineer March 2025 - Present
University of the Arts London (SOAR) funded a major SIEM/SOAR deployment across the workspace architecture, data connectors, KQL-based analytics rules, automated incident response playbooks, and executive workbooks for security reporting.

- Operate as the primary **CrowdStrike Falcon** SME (EDR, Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover): own policy management, detection tuning, alert triage, and proactive threat hunting using ATT&CK-mapped TTPs.
- Serve as senior escalation lead for **incident response**: lead containment, eradication, and recovery for high-severity events, authoring post-incident reports and continuously improving response playbooks.
- Own the **Microsoft Defender** deployment (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across 8,000 users; maintain detection policies, configure investigation workflows, and drive continuous improvement of endpoint protection posture.
- Administer **Microsoft Entra ID** and Conditional Access framework: MFA enforcement, SSO configuration, identity governance, and privileged identity management.
- Manage **BeyondTrust PAM**: privileged account onboarding, least-privilege enforcement, session monitoring, and credential vaulting.
- Run the organisation's **vulnerability management** programme using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS; manage risk-based prioritisation, track remediation against agreed SLAs, and report findings to the security leadership team.
- Administer **Mimecast** email security gateway; manage anti-phishing, URL protection, attachment sandboxing, and simulated phishing campaigns for staff awareness.
- Manage **Microsoft Intune** MDM/MAM: device compliance policies, mobile application management, and enforcement of Conditional Access for the full user estate.
- Oversee **Check Point Harmony** next-generation firewall, IDS/IPS, WAF/DDoS controls, and security certificate management.
- Lead compliance activity against NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, and JISC security frameworks.

University of the Arts London (UAL) – Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Delivered the 24/7 SOC operations, performed alert triage, investigation, and escalation across CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and Microsoft Sentinel SIEM platforms.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID, MFA, Conditional Access, and Group Policy across a multi-site, multi-system user base.
- Administered **Mimecast** email security policies including anti-spam, anti-phishing, and URL filtering.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Nessus and AppCheck; tracked and coordinated remediation with asset and system owners.
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM for mobile device compliance and application policy enforcement.
- Responded to and investigated security incidents including phishing, malware, account compromise, and data access events; authored post-incident reviews.
- Contributed to SIEM detection rule development and SOAR automation workflows, improving alert fidelity and reducing manual triage workload.
- Delivered security awareness training and coordinated simulated phishing exercises across the university.

HGX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) – IT Engineer, Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Implemented and maintained security controls across SaaS, FinTech and on-premises infrastructure in line with ISO 27001 and financial services security standards.
- Managed endpoint protection, patch management, and vulnerability remediation across the corporate IT estate.
- Administered identity and access management controls, enforcing least-privilege and MFA across internal platforms and cloud services.
- Supported network security operations including firewall management, monitoring, and security logging in a FinTech environment.
- Contributed to security documentation including policies, risk assessments, and compliance evidence across quality and infrastructure workstreams.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and built a hybrid **Security Operations Centre (SOC)** capability, combining CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel to provide 24/7 visibility across cloud and on-premises environments.
- Deployed **Microsoft Defender** (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across an 8,000-user estate, establishing unified endpoint and identity threat detection.

- Architected **Microsoft Sentinel** workspace from greenfield, including 20+ data connectors, custom KQL analytics rules, automated playbooks, and executive-level reporting workbooks.
- Implemented **BeyondTrust PAM**, eliminating standing administrative access and enforcing just-in-time privilege management across all critical systems.
- Delivered measurable improvement in mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR) through detection tuning and SOAR automation across CrowdStrike and Sentinel environments.
- Maintained **Cyber Essentials Plus** certification, demonstrating technical assurance across access control, patch management, malware protection, and firewall controls.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 90,000–100,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)